

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 16

Group 16 Vocabulary

1. Antedate

Meaning: To come before something in time.

Tip to remember: “Ante” means before, and “date” means time. Antedate means to have an earlier date.

Sentence: This tradition antedates the modern education system.

2. Banish

Meaning: To force someone to leave; to get rid of something.

Tip to remember: Banish sounds like “ban.” If someone is banished, they are banned from staying.

Sentence: The king decided to banish the traitor from the kingdom.

3. Bridle

Meaning: To restrain or control; also, to react with anger or offense.

Tip to remember: A bridle controls a horse. So bridle means to control or hold back.

Sentence: She bridled at the unfair criticism.

4. Comply

Meaning: To obey or follow a rule, request, or order.

Tip to remember: Comply sounds like “complete reply.” When asked to do something, you complete the request by obeying.

Sentence: All students must comply with the examination rules.

5. Crestfallen

Meaning: Very disappointed or sad.

Tip to remember: Think of a proud bird’s crest falling down after defeat. Crestfallen means emotionally down.

Sentence: He looked crestfallen after hearing that he had not been selected.

6. Curtail

Meaning: To reduce, limit, or cut short.

Tip to remember: Curtail sounds like “cut tail.” To curtail something is to cut it short.

Sentence: The school curtailed outdoor activities because of heavy rain.

7. **Elucidate**
Meaning: To explain clearly or make something easy to understand.
Tip to remember: Elucidate contains “lucid,” meaning clear. To elucidate is to make clear.
Sentence: The professor elucidated the difficult concept with a simple diagram.
8. **Evade**
Meaning: To avoid or escape from something.
Tip to remember: Evade sounds like “avoid.” Both mean to stay away from something.
Sentence: The politician tried to evade the journalist’s question.
9. **Feckless**
Meaning: Weak, irresponsible, or lacking purpose.
Tip to remember: Feckless sounds like “effect-less.” A feckless person produces little useful effect.
Sentence: His feckless leadership caused the project to fail.
10. **Fester**
Meaning: To become worse over time, especially because of neglect.
Tip to remember: Think of an untreated wound getting infected. It festers. Problems can also fester.
Sentence: If ignored, small conflicts can fester into serious disputes.
11. **Iconoclastic**
Meaning: Attacking traditional beliefs, customs, or institutions.
Tip to remember: An icon is a symbol, and clastic means breaking. Iconoclastic means breaking old icons or traditions.
Sentence: His iconoclastic ideas challenged the old teaching methods.
12. **Immure**
Meaning: To imprison, confine, or shut someone inside.
Tip to remember: Immure sounds like “in wall.” Imagine someone trapped inside walls.
Sentence: The prisoner was immured in a dark cell.
13. **Improvise**
Meaning: To create or perform something without preparation.
Tip to remember: Think of speaking in class without notes. You improvise when you make it up on the spot.
Sentence: When the projector failed, she had to improvise her presentation.
14. **Inhibit**
Meaning: To restrict, slow down, or prevent something.
Tip to remember: Inhibit sounds like “in habit.” Bad habits can inhibit your progress.
Sentence: Fear of failure can inhibit creativity.

15. **Inscrutable**

Meaning: Difficult to understand or interpret.

Tip to remember: Scrutinize means to examine closely. Inscrutable means even after scrutiny, it is hard to understand.

Sentence: His inscrutable expression made it impossible to know what he was thinking.

16. **Lionize**

Meaning: To treat someone as very important or famous.

Tip to remember: A lion is treated like the king of animals. To lionize someone is to treat them like a king.

Sentence: The media began to lionize the young inventor.

17. **Monotonous**

Meaning: Boring because it does not change.

Tip to remember: “Mono” means one. A monotonous sound has one tone again and again.

Sentence: The lecturer’s monotonous voice made the class sleepy.

18. **Peculiar**

Meaning: Strange, unusual, or distinctive.

Tip to remember: Think of something so odd that it catches your attention. That is peculiar.

Sentence: There was a peculiar smell coming from the laboratory.

19. **Premeditate**

Meaning: To think about or plan something before doing it, especially a crime.

Tip to remember: “Pre” means before, and “meditate” means think. Premeditate means to think before acting.

Sentence: The attack seemed premeditated rather than accidental.

20. **Profligate**

Meaning: Wasteful, especially with money; morally irresponsible.

Tip to remember: Think of profit flowing out through a gate. A profligate person lets money flow away wastefully.

Sentence: His profligate spending left him in debt.

21. **Reconcile**

Meaning: To restore friendly relations; to make two things consistent.

Tip to remember: Reconcile sounds like “re-connect.” It means to bring people or ideas back together.

Sentence: The two friends reconciled after a long argument.

22. **Refine**

Meaning: To improve by making small changes; to purify.

Tip to remember: Refine means to make something fine again.

Sentence: She refined her essay before submitting it.

23. **Relinquish**

Meaning: To give up or let go of something.

Tip to remember: Relinquish sounds like “release.” To relinquish is to release your hold.

Sentence: He refused to relinquish his dream of studying abroad.

24. **Ruminate**

Meaning: To think deeply and repeatedly about something.

Tip to remember: Cows ruminate by chewing again and again. People ruminate by thinking again and again.

Sentence: She ruminated over her career choices for several days.

25. **Skittish**

Meaning: Nervous, easily frightened, or restless.

Tip to remember: Think of a nervous kitten jumping at every sound. That is skittish.

Sentence: The skittish horse ran away when it heard thunder.

26. **Superfluous**

Meaning: Unnecessary; more than needed.

Tip to remember: Superfluous sounds like “super flow.” If too much is flowing, it is extra and unnecessary.

Sentence: Remove the superfluous details from your answer.

27. **Synoptic**

Meaning: Giving a general summary or overall view.

Tip to remember: Synoptic sounds like “summary optic.” It gives a view of the whole picture.

Sentence: The teacher gave a synoptic overview of the entire chapter.

28. **Thorough**

Meaning: Complete, detailed, and careful.

Tip to remember: Think of checking every corner of a room. A thorough person misses nothing.

Sentence: The engineer made a thorough inspection of the system.

29. **Visionary**

Meaning: Having original ideas about the future; imaginative and forward-thinking.

Tip to remember: Visionary comes from vision. A visionary person sees future possibilities.

Sentence: The visionary leader invested early in renewable energy.

30. **Vociferous**

Meaning: Loud and forceful in expressing opinions.

Tip to remember: “Voci” relates to voice. Vociferous people use their voice loudly.

Sentence: The workers were vociferous in demanding better wages.